

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms such as feeling sad for a long time , feeling helpless , having worsening suicidal thoughts , and energy and concentration problems indicate symptoms of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD). Anhedonia (lack of pleasure in normally enjoyable activities) is a key symptom of MDD , and the patient mentions feeling hopeless and lacking energy , which is consistent with this disorder . Additionally , the worsening suicidal ideation is often associated with this diagnosis . </think><answer> The patient is likely to show anhedonia </answer>

